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Hiring Team, Pepper

Your posting says this is an operating seat, not a strategy seat, and the line that stuck with me is the one about handing someone a sentence instead of a brief. I am the Founder and CEO of PriceKeel right now, and that is the whole job: I designed the guardrail engine and audit trail from a blank page, set up the CRM, CPQ, forecast and pipeline reviews myself, and I am running pilots while raising the company's first round. Nobody wrote me a playbook either. I wrote one and I am still testing it.

The function-with-no-owner part of your posting is also a real thing I have already done. At Sensata, the Bleeders and Leakers program did not exist until I built it: I ranked 1,200 pricing opportunities against a $627M target across 3 regions, negotiated $700K plus of margin back in two quarters, and lifted distributor margins from 53% to 61% by repricing the logic itself so the fix held past the first cycle. I got promoted from Product and Growth Marketing to Pricing Lead in 10 months on the back of it, which is the part that tells you it kept running once I handed the reporting cadence to the team.

Your note on rebuilding manual work AI-first is already my day job. At Applied Materials I converted a repetitive, manual analysis workflow into one run by agents built on Claude, freeing the hours for the judgment calls a dashboard cannot make. And the customer-retention piece, especially where it is US-facing, is where I started: at Pixis I hired and managed an 8-person team running 8 client accounts and cut churn 50% by fixing account strategy and retention mechanics at the root instead of discounting the symptom.

What I would bring on day one is a founder who is comfortable being handed a sentence, the operating discipline of someone who has run OKRs and quarterly reviews inside a public company, and a habit of thinking in margin, CAC and payback before I think in activity. Proof trail at adhithyabhaskar.vercel.app/ref/pepper.

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